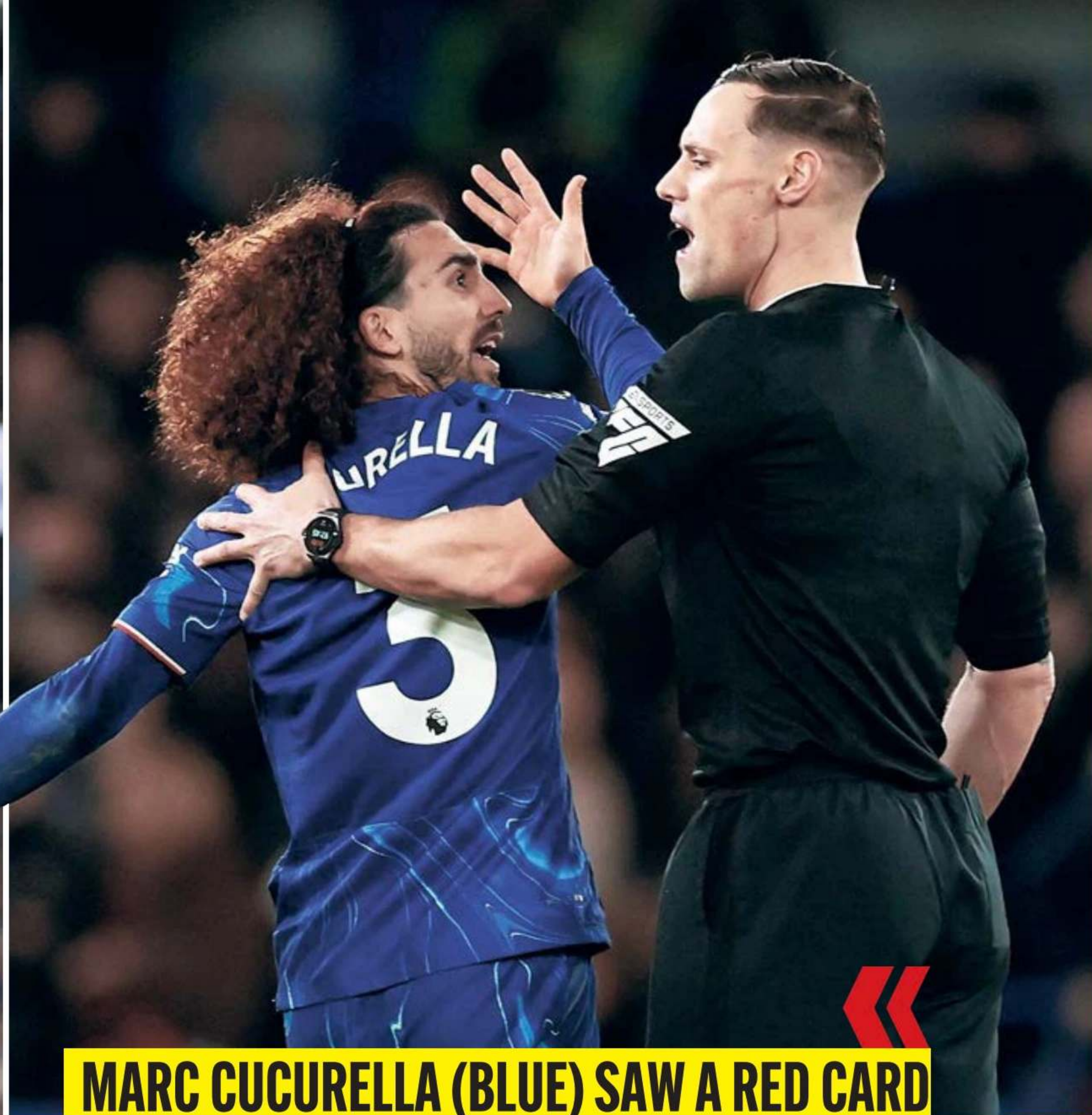




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MARC CUCURELLA (BLUE) SAW A RED CARD IN THE EIGHTH MINUTE OF SECOND-HALF STOPPAGE TIME DURING CHELSEA'S 2-1 WIN AGAINST BRENTFORD

Down to the wire: Lisandro Martinez (left) scored the winner as Amorim's men scored two goals in two minutes to script a brilliant comeback win. GETTY IMAGES

manager (4-1 in the Champions League), had his task cut out and turned heads after deciding to drop Marcus Rashford and Alejandro Garnacho from the starting line-up.

City, playing in front of home support at the Etihad, got the crowd in a celebratory mood with Joško Gvardiol opening the scoring in the 36th minute with a well-taken header. While United did not look

rudderless with its off-the-ball movement, the Red Devils could not take their chances, and time was running out. Minutes away from a win, the Etihad crowd was silenced by a late collapse.

Matheus Nunes, who gave the ball away cheaply in the final third, brought down Amad Diallo in the box in a bid to win it back and ended up bringing down the United forward. Referee Anthony Taylor quickly pointed to the penalty spot, and Guardiola had his hands on his head. Bruno Fernandes stepped up to take the spot-kick and never looked in doubt as he sent Ederson the wrong way for the equaliser in the 88th minute.

Considering the circumstances, a draw would have been a good result for both teams, but City had more disappointment in store. Lisandro Martínez spotted Diallo's forward run and found him with an excellent lofted through ball. The Ivory Coast international lifted the ball past an onrushing Ederson with immaculate precision and slotted it into the net from a tight angle. United had scored two goals in two minutes to script a brilliant comeback win in the derby.

Liverpool, which looks on course to win their 20th league title, was left frustrated by a 2-2 draw against Fulham, but manager Arne Slot praised his team's resilience in